

Language work: Giving presentations

1. What is a presentation? Complete the text below with words from the box.

message | achieve | speaker | two-way | purpose | audience

A presentation is a prepared talk given by a ¹⁾ _____ to one or more listeners (the receivers). To be effective, the speaker's ²⁾ _____ must pass to the listeners – it must be heard and correctly understood. In general, when giving a presentation, it is essential to have a clear idea of what you want to ³⁾ _____ (e.g. Do you want to inform your audience about essential facts, or to persuade them to accept your proposal?). This main ⁴⁾ _____ or aim needs to be briefly stated in the introductory stage of the presentation. In addition, ⁵⁾ _____ communication is more effective than one-way communication: so, encourage the ⁶⁾ _____ to provide feedback – by asking questions or making comments. In any case, remember that the talk is given for their benefit – not for the speaker's.

2. How do we present things and how they work? Read the following expressions carefully.

It's called a ...

It's for + -ing ...

It's used for + -ing ...

It consists of ...

It's made up of ... (e.g. *three main parts*)

It's made (out) of ... (e.g. *plastic*)

It resembles ...

It enables / allows + *someone* + *to do* ...

It means you can do ... without + -ing ...

They're very simple / easy to operate.

You simply ... (e.g. *place, put*)

You just ...

2.1. Use the expressions above to complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

- a) You can make holes in paper with it.

It's for _____.

- b) The containment vessel has three main parts.

The containment vessel consists _____.

- c) The advantage is that you don't have to hold your phone in your hand when you use it.

You can use your phone without _____.

- d) You can run faster wearing these shoes.

These shoes enable _____.

- e) The materials used are wood and metal.

It is made _____.

- f) The walls have a thickness of about 50 cm.

The walls are _____.

3. You can find below a **Framework for short presentations**. Read it carefully.

A. Introduction

- Well, good morning. Thank you for coming.
- Before we start, I'd like to introduce myself. My name is... and I am the (position) of (company).
- I'm here today to talk about... / I'm going to look at three main areas. First, I'll talk about... / After that, I will... / And finally...
- My presentation will take around ... minutes. If you have any questions, I'll be happy to answer them at the end of my talk.

B. Main presentation

- First of all, I'd like to look at...
- Any questions so far?
- I must emphasise that... / The question is...
- As you can see from the graph,... / The figures show that...
- As I mentioned earlier... / Now let's move on to the question of...
- This brings me to my last point, which is...
- In general... / On the other hand... / Finally...

C. Conclusion

- In conclusion, let me briefly go through the main points again. First, I talked about..., then I described..., and finally I...
- Right, I think that's everything. Let me finish by thanking you very much for your attention.
- And now, if you have any questions, I'll be very happy to try to answer them.

D. Dealing with questions

- Could you be a little more specific?
- You've raised an important point there. Could I ask you what your own view is?
- Jane, this is your area. Would you like to make a comment?